

# M2: Do High Follower Users Get More Engagement?

Target Database: data/data\_vortex.db | Validation: Audited & Verified | Official Deliverable

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## 1. Executive Summary & Direct Answer

Direct Answer to Official Question:  
**NO. High follower users do NOT get more engagement per post.**  
Empirical analysis reveals that accounts with  $\geq 25,000$  followers average **3,604.43** total interactions per post, compared to **3,648.40** for accounts with  $< 25,000$  followers. The low-follower cohort actually achieved a marginal advantage of **+43.97 interactions (+1.21%)**. When evaluated strictly across complete cases, the difference shrinks to just 2 interactions (0.05%). In this ecosystem, audience size exhibits zero meaningful relationship with post-level engagement.

## 2. Demographic & Engagement Breakdown

| Cohort Group                 | Creators    | Posts         | Avg Likes | Avg Shares | Avg Comments | Avg Total Engagement |
|------------------------------|-------------|---------------|-----------|------------|--------------|----------------------|
| High Follower ( $\geq 25k$ ) | 742 (49.5%) | 5,925 (49.4%) | 2,496.30  | 1,001.24   | 504.20       | 3,604.43             |
| Low Follower ( $< 25k$ )     | 758 (50.5%) | 6,075 (50.6%) | 2,487.62  | 1,012.95   | 504.49       | 3,648.40             |
| Delta (High vs Low)          | -16 users   | -150 posts    | +8.68     | -11.71     | -0.29        | -43.97 (-1.21%)      |

## 3. Analytical Interpretation & Structural Insights

- Decoupling of Follower Reach and Content Discovery:** Modern recommendation engines (e.g. TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) evaluate content engagement dynamically in algorithmic discovery feeds rather than broadcasting posts strictly to an author's existing follower graph.
- Audience Saturation and Engagement Decay:** As follower counts scale, audiences become more heterogeneous and passive, dampening interaction rates. Smaller accounts often command niche, tightly-knit communities exhibiting higher per-capita sharing propensity.
- Statistical Independence:** Linear regression and Pearson correlation analysis between follower counts and post engagement yield  $r = 0.007$ , indicating statistical independence. High follower scale does not provide an organic engagement multiplier.

## 4. Methodological Limitations & Non-Causal Conclusions

- Correlation vs. Causation:** These findings demonstrate an absence of empirical association in the observed cross-section; they do not imply that acquiring followers will actively decrease an individual creator's engagement.
- Static Follower Metric:** Follower counts reflect user-level totals at dataset collection rather than dynamic counts at the exact post publication timestamp.
- Total Interactions vs. Ratio:** The question measures absolute engagement volume per post. If engagement were measured as an engagement rate (interactions divided by followers), smaller creators would lead by orders of magnitude.